

2024

JavaScript Rising Stars

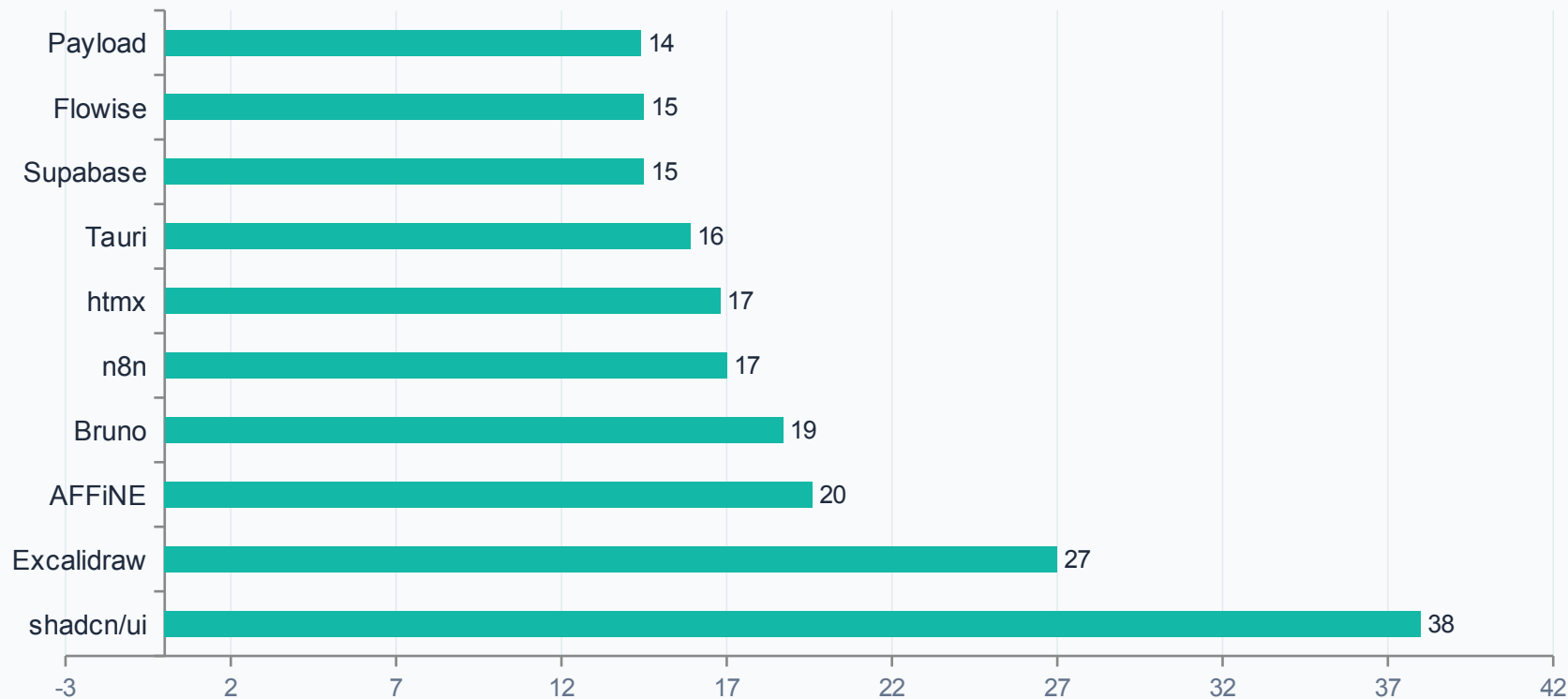
Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

Based on GitHub stars added in 2024 | 9th Annual Edition | Source: risingstars.js.org

For Frontend Engineers & Engineering Managers

Top 10 Most-Starred Projects

shadcn/ui dominates with +38k stars in 2024



CHAMPION 2024

shadcn/ui: Back-to-Back Winner

77.5k

Total Stars

since Jan 2023

38.0k

Added in 2024

vs 39.5k in 2023

#1

Overall Rank

2nd consecutive year

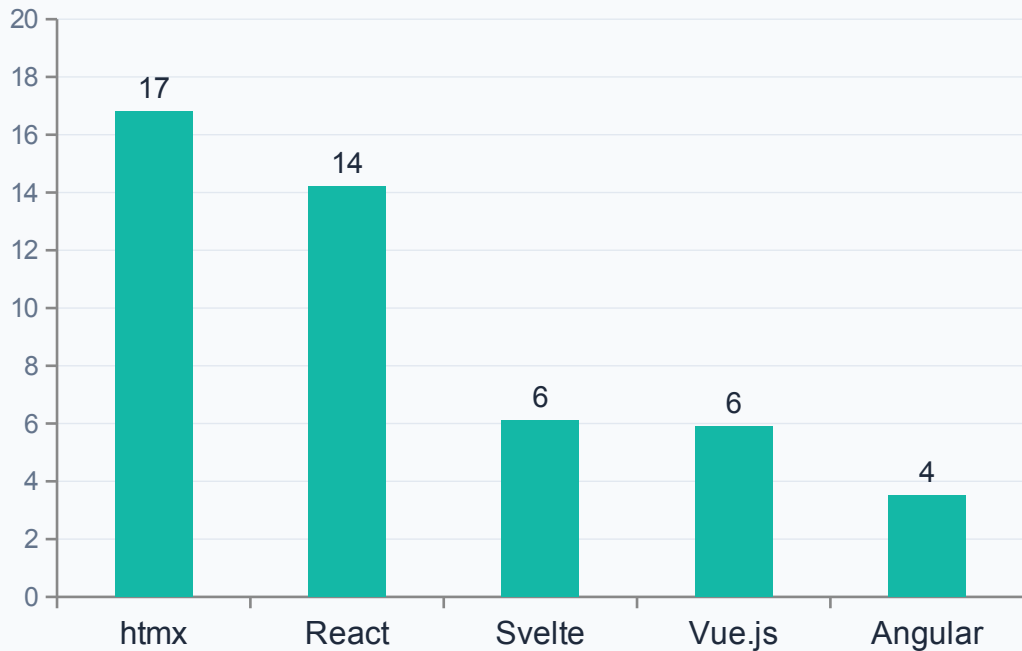
Key 2024 Additions

- Charts (powered by Recharts)
- Themes (CSS variable generation)
- Blocks (layout collections for web apps)
- Responsive sidebar component
- CLI with multi-framework support: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos

Spawned ecosystem derivatives: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI + integration with Vercel's v0 for AI-generated components

Frontend Frameworks Shakeup

htmx overtakes React as #1 by stars added



htmx Philosophy

Extends HTML with `hx-*` attributes for AJAX, WebSockets, server-driven interactivity without JavaScript

React 19 Release

Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements, new hooks, form actions — React evolving toward "specification for frameworks"

Svelte 5 introduced "runes" — explicit reactive state mechanism. Holds highest positive opinion in State of JS survey.

React Ecosystem

Top 5 by GitHub Stars Added in 2024

#1	#2	#3	#4	#5
shadcn/ui	Excalidraw	Payload	Magic UI	Next.js
+38.0k	+27.0k	+14.4k	+13.2k	+12.1k
stars added	stars added	stars added	stars added	stars added

React's Evolution: From Library to Framework Specification

With React 19's Server Components and Server Functions, multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix, etc.) now interpret React's primitives differently. As Robin Wieruch noted, React is evolving from a library into "a specification for frameworks" — a shift toward framework-first mindset while still allowing client-only usage.

Vue Ecosystem

Top 5 by GitHub Stars Added in 2024

#1	#2	#3	#4	#5
Nuxt	PrimeVue	Slidev	shadcn-vue	VitePress
+6.2k	+5.4k	+4.7k	+4.1k	+3.7k
stars added	stars added	stars added	stars added	stars added

Vue 3.5 Reactivity Overhaul & Ecosystem Maturity

Vue 3.5 reworked its reactivity system with the lighter alien-signals approach landing in main branch. Daniel Roe (Nuxt core team lead) highlighted the active release cycle and regular performance improvements. Flourishing of Vue UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) signals growing ecosystem confidence.

Emerging Themes in 2024

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation

AI-Powered Projects

n8n +17.0k

Workflow automation with native AI

Flowise +14.5k

Drag & drop UI for custom LLM flows

AFFiNE +19.6k

Knowledge base with AI capabilities

Desktop & Mobile

Tauri +15.9k

Lighter desktop/mobile apps with web tech

Browser Innovation

PGLite New

Postgres via WebAssembly

WebVM New

Virtual machine running in browser

Supabase +14.5k

Open-source Firebase alternative

4 of top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities or integrations

Key Takeaways

What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1 Component Ownership Beats Imports

shadcn/ui's model of letting developers own and customize component code proved its staying power for a second year

2 HTML-First Is Serious

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures

3 React Is Becoming a Framework Spec

With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently

4 AI Integration Is Table Stakes

Four of the top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities — this is now an expectation, not a differentiator

5 Vue's UI Library Ecosystem Signals Maturity

High-quality UI libraries and Vue 3.5's reactivity overhaul demonstrate a confident, maturing ecosystem

Looking Ahead to 2025: Component ownership, HTML-first approaches, and AI integration are the defining trends.